Types of Malware

Understanding Malicious Software Threats

A Guide to Common Cyber Security Threats

What is Malware?

> **Malware (malicious software) is any software intentionally designed to cause damage to computers, servers, networks, or users. It includes viruses, worms, trojans, ransomware, spyware, and other harmful programs that can steal data, damage systems, or disrupt operations.**

Think of it Like...

Digital Diseases and Parasites: Just like biological viruses and parasites attack living organisms to survive and spread, malware attacks computer systems to steal information, cause damage, or use resources for criminal purposes. Some spread rapidly like contagious diseases, while others hide quietly like parasites.

Major Malware Categories

Viruses	Worms
Attach to legitimate files and spread when files are shared or executed	Self-replicating programs that spread across networks without user action

Trojans	Ransomware
Disguise themselves as legitimate software to trick users into installation	Encrypts files and demands payment for decryption keys

Spyware	Adware
Secretly monitors and collects user information without consent	Displays unwanted advertisements and tracks browsing habits

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Remember: Malware threats constantly evolve, but following security best practices significantly reduces infection risk. Always maintain multiple layers of protection and keep security software current. When in doubt, don't click, download, or install suspicious content.

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